



Jeff Cunningham's Coldsnap Review, Part 2: Red and Artifacts

Jeff continues his examination of the Coldsnap cards with an in-depth look at the Red and Artifact offerings. Is Stalking Yeti the new Flametongue Kavu? Is Lovisa Coldeyes a credible player? Is Lightning Storm the most confusing burn spell ever? Read on to find out!



[\[Jeff's Coldsnap Review, Part I: White\]](#)

By [Jeff Cunningham](#) | July 18, 2006

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Well hello again. Good to see you, friend.

Step inside, warm yourself by the fire... and let us talk once more of Dominaria...

Constructed Staple: This is going to see heavy play, e.g. [Shuhei Nakamura](#). Good: This is going to see play, e.g. Akira Asahara. Fringe: This is going to see marginal play, e.g. Itaru Ishida. Maybe: This card might see play, but probably not, e.g. Soo Han Yoon. N/A: Let's not kid ourselves, e.g. Masahashi's GF.

Limited Bomb: The only way to react to opening this card in Limited is by a comically exaggerated rubbing of the eyes, e.g. Richard Hoaen. Good: A reasonable first-pick, e.g. [Gab Tsang](#). Solid: Your classic good man, e.g. Elijah Pollock. Playable: Some of the time you'll run it, some of the time you won't, e.g. Paul "the muscle" Russel. N/A: Even a perfunctory knowledge of the game prohibits the inclusion of this card, e.g. Alex Sibzthorpe.

Red

Commons

[Goblin Furrier](#)

Constructed: N/A. The days of the Ironclaw Orc are dead.
 Limited: Playable. (Note: only Red 2-drop.)

[Goblin Rimerunner](#)

Constructed: N/A. The days of the Grey Ogre are *really* dead. Limited: Solid. Prevents the situation, which does come up, of having your entire army held off by a 2/4.

[Icefall](#)

Constructed: Fringe. With double-lands still in the format for a while, this is sure to see at least some play. [Recover](#) is definitely relevant here; I'm just not sure how relevant yet. Limited: N/A.

[Karplusan Wolverine](#)

Constructed: Maybe. Fairly difficult to block, but would even a 1/1 R Unblockable creature be worth playing over some of the other options? Limited: Playable.

[Martyr of Ashes](#)

Constructed: Maybe. Seems potentially reasonable in the sideboard of that all-burn deck, or even in a Zoo sideboard versus WW/Boros. Probably not. Limited: Solid. Like [Soulscur](#), the design of this card does add up; you want to slow-roll your ground guys to avoid the [Earthquake](#), and so you'll have them in hand anyway. Otherwise, you can just run it out and hope for a good opportunity, or that they'll make a mistake on the number of Red cards you have in hand. That's pretty respectable for a one-drop.

This card's very existence is going to affect a ton of Limited games, as players strive to play around it.

[Ohran Yeti](#)

Constructed: N/A Limited: Good. Classic [Hill Giant](#) with a fairly relevant ability.

[Orcish Bloodpainter](#)



Constructed: N/A Limited: Good. Can probably do the last four or five points if need be, and makes combat easier.

[Rite of Flame](#)

Constructed: Fringe. The only question is how bad you want that turn 2 [Rumbling Slum...](#)

This type of card has pretty versatile application – the right combo deck, or the right beatdown deck – and I expect it to see play in at least Standard at some point.

Limited: N/A

[Skred](#)

Constructed: Maybe. If you play all Snow-Covered lands, this will eventually kill just about anything for only one mana, which seems passable. Limited: Good. The price is right, even if you have to roll it until turn 5, and it's removal with the potential to kill a big creature.

[Surging Flame](#)

Constructed: Maybe. I can't imagine playing this over [Volcanic Hammer](#), but this seems like it would suit some sort of all-burn deck. Limited: Good.

[Thermopod](#)

Constructed: N/A. I know it's a slug made out of fire... that's pretty rad, but I just don't see it happening. Sac'ing all your guys up for big [Demonfires](#) is something that might pass in Block, but not anywhere else. Limited: Solid.

Uncommons

[Balduvian Rage](#)

Constructed: N/A. Limited: Playable. I think it's rare that it'll do that much, but it still cycles.

[Balduvian Warlord](#)

Constructed: N/A Limited: Solid. The ability doesn't seem game-breaking, and a 3/2 on its own is nothing special. I'm possibly underrating.

[Cryoclastm](#)

Constructed: Good. This will see play in sideboards, probably in Extended too. Three-mana land destruction is obviously nothing to write home about (especially when it can't kill a double land), but the decks that used to sideboard [Stone Rain](#) for control matchups will probably like this. Limited: Solid. Good card to pick up for the sideboard.

[Earthen Goo](#)

Constructed: N/A. I don't see it happening with so many more efficient options available (Vinelasher Kudzu). Limited: Good (R/G) Playable (Other). I don't know if I would play it except in R/G, but in that it's probably going to make a dent.

[Greater Stone Spirit](#)

Constructed: N/A. It hits hard, but just isn't efficient enough. Limited: Good. Seems a little bit better than [Oathsworn Giant](#).

[Lightning Storm](#)

Constructed: Maybe. Ah, what a clever little battle of wits. You can store extra land to try and dome for 7 or 9, but if you go overboard they might be able to counter it. But if you don't quite go overboard, and they counter it, you use their own lands against them when you send it back to deal a colossal amount of damage.

The bad part is a situation where you just play this out turn 3 to kill a blocker, and they have a couple extra land on you, and you get devastated.

All things considered, seems like it might see a bit of play.

Sandy: I don't know. I mean, it sounds like a good daydream but actually doing it is too weird. It's too dangerous. Jeffrey: Sandy, let's just try the first part. No one will suspect us. Because no one would think two people like us would be crazy enough to do something like this. Sandy: You have a point there.

Limited: Solid/Good. The worst case scenario is still the one mentioned above – wanting to use it, but opening yourself to the possibility of getting wrecked by an opponent's otherwise-terrible land heavy draw. That said, if they don't know it's coming, you can milk it hard and long in the late game, for as much as you need to.

[Magmatic Core](#)

Constructed: N/A. Burn/Boros deck, sideboard for the mirror, or non-Enchantment removal creature decks? I don't see it happening – too slow. And they just save their creatures up until after it's gone. Limited: Good/Bomb. If you're in any position to stall the board while this is in play, the game should be over pretty quick.

[Stalking Yeti](#)

Constructed: Good. It's no [Flametongue Kavu](#), but it's not bad. I can see this in any sort of Zoo or Boros deck as a sideboard against other creature decks. Maybe even maindeck, or in Extended. Limited: Bomb. Efficient, provides inevitability. Little, yellow, different.

Rares

[Braid of Fire](#)

Constructed: Fringe. The Japanese might break this. Limited: N/A. [Raphael Levy](#) won't.

[Fury of the Horde](#)

Constructed: Maybe. Nothing with a big effect that's *free* is that easy to write off. I don't see it personally, but maybe I'm not thinking hard enough. (I basically only ever learned R/G beatdown and U/W control.)

All I know is: [Llanowar Elf](#) + [Rumbling Slum](#) + [Psychotic Fury](#) + [Fury of the Horde](#) = DG.

Limited: Playable... if you're really hard up/ looking to peel big.

[Karplusan Minotaur](#)

Constructed: Maybe. A curious little fellow indeed. The obvious inherent break in this card's symmetry is that, as the Red player, damage done to you is usually far less relevant than the damage done to your opponent. That said, this card is competing with cards like [Rumbling Slum](#) and [Stalking Yeti](#). But I wouldn't be too surprised if I saw it turn up eventually. Limited: Solid/Good.

[Lightning Serpent](#)

Constructed: Maybe – I guess. Five mana for a [Ball Lightning](#) doesn't seem that hot... by the time you want to be spending mana on this thing, you probably want a finisher that's more reliable, like [Demonfire](#). Limited: Playable. This is no [Demonfire](#), but it can make a dent if it

catches someone by surprise.

[Lovisa Coldeyes](#)

Constructed: Maybe. Of course, +2/+2's pretty tempting. [Balduvian Barbarians](#), Zo-Zu, [Orcish Artillery](#), an endless stream of 2/1s for two, [Frenzied Goblin](#), [Raging Goblin](#), [Simian Brawler](#), [Boreal Centaur](#), and [Scab-Clan Mauler](#) actually comprise a reasonable base.

Think about it, that's all I ask.

Limited: Playable.

[Rimescale Dragon](#)

Constructed: Maybe. Kiega et al work hard at six mana. For seven, I don't think it's worth it. Might have a home after the rotation. Limited: Bomb.

Artifact

Uncommons

[Coldsteel Heart](#)

Constructed: Fringe. The Signets are pretty damn functional, but after they rotate out, I see no reason why this couldn't be used. Also will probably be the choice in decks where Snow permanents are relevant. Limited: Good. With so few other accelerators available, this is good.

[Mishra's Bauble](#)

Constructed: Good. Makes playing 56 card decks pretty feasible. The primary downside is having less information about your opening hand while deciding to mulligan. Limited: Playable. Fine, but obviously not worth taking over anything you'd want to play with.

[Phyrexian Ironfoot](#)

Constructed: Maybe – worse has been played. But that was a long time ago. Limited: Solid. A fine body... the only



concern is whether Snow mana will be prevalent enough that you can always at least pay the mana when you want to.



[Phyrexian Snowcrusher](#)

Constructed: N/A Limited: Good.

Rares

[Jester's Scepter](#)

Constructed: N/A. There is no Glimpse deck. Limited: N/A

[Phyrexian Soulgorger](#)

Constructed: N/A Limited: N/A. For both formats I can *almost* see it – you sac your one or two drop, and hit them for eight. This plan is so full of holes though – leaves you open for a two-for-one, they can chump block, you can draw the 'gorger without drawing another creature.

[Thrumming Stone](#)

Constructed: Maybe – but I'm not going to be the one to crack it. Limited: N/A

Notable Coldsnap Red Cards – Constructed 1. [Stalking Yeti](#) (Uncommon) 2. [Icefall](#) (Common) 3. [Rite of Flame](#) (Common) 4. [Braid of Fire](#) (Rare)

Notable Coldsnap Artifacts – Constructed 1. [Mishra's Bauble](#) (Uncommon) 2. [Coldsteel Heart](#) (Uncommon)

Coldsnap Red Common Pick Order – Limited 1. [Surging Flame](#) 2. [Skred](#) 3. [Ohran Yeti](#) 4. [Orcish Bloodpainter](#) 5. [Goblin Rimerunner](#) 6. [Thermopod](#) 7. [Martyr of Ashes](#) 8. [Karplusan Wolverine](#) 9. [Goblin Furrier](#) 10. [Rite of Flame](#) 11. [Icefall](#)

Canadian Nationals Preview #2: The Assassination of [Jeff Cunningham](#) by the Coward Taylor Putnam

Taylor blazed onto the scene last season with a Finals appearance at Grand Prix Seattle, which he followed up with... well, we're still working on that part.

The point is this: unlike his former patron, [Murray Evans](#), Taylor playtests hard, and has a bit of fire left in the belly.

His Achilles heel? A treacherous streak the size of Rhode [Island](#).

4-1 at Charleston, I sat down to play Round 6 against [Rasmus Sibast](#). I was with WGU Glare, and he had RGU Control – typically a great matchup for him. He took Game 1 unceremoniously, but Game 2 I had my plan ready: [Dovescape](#)/[Chord of Calling](#)—no one was prepared for it.

Except... Rasmus, somehow, was. He played around the combo the entire second game, as if he knew. I was baffled. After he just *narrowly* pulled out the win, I had to ask: “how did you know?”

“A little birdy told me,” he shrugged in Taylor’s general direction.

Putnam.

A man I had called friend. Team-drafted with in earnest. Shared my deck with in confidence at his request. “I’m not even B seat!” he had said. Taylor would later claim that it had been an anonymous man in the crowd who had shouted to Rasmus my deck.

We shared a look. He knew I knew. He looked ashamed.

Neither of us spoke until, after a moment, I dug a [Liar’s Pendulum](#) and a sharpie out of my knapsack and tersely requested his John Hancock. “It’s just that I’m such a huge fan of your work” I spat, before reeling in disgust, and breaking into a jerky trot towards the exit.

I have forgiven Taylor, but I have not forgotten.

Predicted finish: Top 8

Tomorrow: Green and Lands.

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